

Integrated Science

WACE written examination—2010 design brief

Stage 2

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes

Working time for paper: three hours

Permissible items

Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighter

Special items: non-programmable scientific calculator, drawing instruments and templates

Additional information

The examination places emphasis on practical scenarios and short answer items. Each question contains a scenario where information is given in discrete parts. Linked questions are sequenced to increase in complexity.

The examination is presented in a question/answer booklet with a separate multiple-choice answer sheet. A data insert sheet (A4 booklet size) is provided if required.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Multiple-choice 20% of the written exam 20 questions Suggested working time: 30 minutes	Questions sample student understanding of scientific method and scientific concepts. Candidates indicate their answers on the separate multiple-choice answer sheet provided.
Section Two Short answer 60% of the written exam 4–6 questions Suggested working time: 110 minutes	Questions are structured as a sequence of items linked to a variety of scenarios. Questions provide opportunities for candidates to apply learned concepts, principles and strategies to solve problems set in unfamiliar scenarios. Question may involve descriptions, diagrams, tables or graphs. At least one question in this section samples the candidate's understanding of experimental design in an unfamiliar investigation. The remaining questions sample the candidate's understanding of scientific concepts.
Section Three Extended answer 20% of the written exam Two questions Suggested working time: 40 minutes	Questions are holistic in nature and scaffolded. Candidates interpret and respond to questions that may include stimulus materials such as diagrams, second-hand data, excerpts from publications and recent research findings. The stimulus material should not exceed one page in length.